A

Abhava (absence): considered a basic constituent of reality (***padartha***) by the ***Nyaya-Vaisheshikas***, who hold that absences are perceptible. It is always the absence of something known to be real, which is technically termed the ***pratiyogin*** (counter-positive). That there is no jar on the table translates as, 'there is absence of jar on the table'. This is a true negative fact. If true propositions have actual, objective truth-makers, absences must be realities, although not actualities. The absence of, say, an obstruction, is just as much a reality as the presence of one. Although the hole in the bucket is not a positive entity (*bhava*), being just the absence of some material, it's real enough.

The *Nyaya-Vaisheshika* realists classify absence into four sorts:

Prag-abhava (prior absence) has an end but no beginning. It is the non-existence of any product prior to its origination: for example, the non-existence in curds in milk prior to their formation.

Pradhvamsa-abhava (destruction) has a beginning but no end: the non-existence of milk once the curds have formed.